



INTRODUCTION TO ANNUAL REPORT

Every year, a corporation publishes an Annual Report (AR) for shareholders and other interested parties. Released by the conclusion of the fiscal year, the information in the AR is current as of March 31. Typically, the AR is available as a PDF document on the company's website (usually in the investor section), or one can request a paper copy from the company.

Since the AR is an official document, all information stated is taken as accurate and reliable. Any falsification in the annual report can be used against the corporation. To ensure integrity, the AR includes auditor's certificates that are signed, dated, and sealed, attesting to the accuracy of the financial information. The primary recipients of the annual report are current shareholders and prospective investors. The report includes essential facts and the main message the company wants to convey. It is the first place an investor should look for information about a company. While many media websites claim to provide financial data about companies, investors should rely on information directly from the annual report as it is more trustworthy.

The annual report usually contains the following nine sections:

- Financial Highlights
- The Management Statement
- Management Discussion and Analysis
- 10-year Financial Highlights
- Corporate Information
- Director's Report
- Report on Corporate Governance
- Financial Section
- Notice

These sections collectively provide a comprehensive overview of the company's performance, governance, and financial health, making the annual report a crucial resource for investors.



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